

Homework 2, Week 3

Text B

Source Text and Paragraph Analysis

Spanglish Spoken Here

by Janice Castro

1. In Manhattan a first-grader greets her visiting grandparents, happily exclaiming, "Come here, sientate!" Her **bemused** grandfather, who does not speak Spanish, nevertheless knows she is asking him to sit down. A Miami personnel officer understands what a job applicant means when he says, "Quiero un part time." Nor do drivers miss a beat reading a billboard alongside a Los Angeles street advertising CERVEZA-SIX-PACK! ***(Introduce the situations in which the Spanglish is used and introduce the topic)***
2. This free-form blend of Spanish and English, known as Spanglish, is common **linguistic** currency wherever concentrations of Hispanic Americans are found in the U.S. In Los Angeles, where 55 percent of the city's three million inhabitants speak Spanish, Spanglish is as much a part of daily life as sunglasses. Unlike the broken-English efforts of earlier immigrants from Europe, Asia, and other regions, Spanglish has become a widely accepted conversational mode used casually-even playfully-by Spanish-speaking immigrants and native-born Americans alike. ***(Introduce the meaning, the universality and the origin of Spanglish)***
3. Consisting of one part **Hispanicized** English, one part Americanized Spanish, and more than a little **fractured** syntax, Spanglish is a bit like a Robin Williams comedy routine, a crackling line of cross-cultural patter straight from the melting pot. Often it enters **Anglo** homes and families through the children, who pick it up at school or at play with their young Hispanic contemporaries. In other cases, it comes from watching TV; many an Anglo child watching Sesame Street has learned uno dos tres almost as quickly as one two three. ***(Show the inherit and spread of Spanglish)***
4. Spanglish takes a variety of forms, from the Southern California **Anglos** who bid **farewell** with the utterly silly "hasta la bye-bye" to the **Cuban** American drivers in Miami who **parquean** their **carros**. Some Spanglish sentences are mostly Spanish, with a quick **detour** for an English word or two. A Latino friend may cut short a conversation by glancing at his watch and excusing himself with the explanation that he must "ir al supermarket." ***(Utter that there are a variety of forms of Spanglish among different people)***

5. Many of the English words transplanted in this way are simply **handier** than their Spanish counterparts. No matter how distasteful the subject, for example, it is still easier to say "income tax" than impuesto sobre la renta. At the same time, many Spanish-speaking immigrants have adopted such terms as VCR, microwave, and dishwasher for what they view as largely American phenomena. Still other English words convey a cultural context that is not implicit in the Spanish. A friend who invites you to lonche most likely has in mind the brisk American custom of "doing lunch" rather than the **languorous** afternoon break traditionally implied **byalmuerzo**. ***(Explain the phenomenon that English transplanted in Spanish is simpler and handier than pure Spanish)***
6. Mainstream Americans exposed to similar hybrids of German, Chinese, or Hindi might be **mystified**. But even Anglos who speak little or no Spanish are somewhat familiar with Spanglish. Living among them, for one thing, are 19 million **Hispanics**. In addition, more American high school and university students sign up for Spanish than for any other foreign language. ***(State the wide use and familiarity of Spanish in Americans)***
7. Only in the past ten years, though, has Spanglish begun to turn into a national **slang**. Its popularity has grown with the explosive increases in U.S. immigration from Latin American countries. English has increasingly **collided** with Spanish in retail stores, offices and classrooms, in pop music and on street corners. Anglos whose ancestors picked up such Spanish words as rancho, bronco, tornado, and incommunicado, for instance, now freely use such Spanish words as gracias, bueno, amigo, and por favor. ***(Utter the immigration from Latin American countries leads to the increase popularity of Spanglish in many ways)***
8. Among Latinos, Spanglish conversations often flow easily from Spanish into several sentences of English and back again. "It is done unconsciously," explains Carmen Silva-Corvalan, a Chilean-born associate professor of linguistics at the University of Southern California, who speaks Spanglish with relatives and neighbors. "I couldn't even tell you minutes later if I said something in Spanish or in English." ***(The conversion between Spanish and English is unconscious since they are both Latinos)***
9. Spanglish is a sort of code for Latinos: the speakers know Spanish, but their hybrid language reflects the American culture in which they live. Many lean to shorter, clipped phrases in place of the longer, more graceful expressions their parents used. Says Leonel de la Cuesta, an assistant professor of modern languages at Florida International University in Miami: "In the U.S., time is money, and that is showing up in Spanglish as an economy of language." Conversational examples: **taipiar** (type) and **winshi-wiper** (windshield wiper) replace **escribir a maquina** and **limpiaparabrisas**. ***(The importance of Spanglish in the way of blending cultures and adapting to American culture)***
10. Major advertisers, eager to tap the estimated \$134 billion in spending power **wielded** by Spanish-speaking Americans, have ventured into Spanglish to promote their products. In some cases, attempts to **sprinkle** Spanish through commercials have produced embarrassing **gaffes**. A Braniff airlines ad that sought to tell Spanish-speaking audiences

they could settle back en (in) luxuriant cuero (leather) seats, for example, inadvertently said they could fly without clothes (encuero). A fractured translation of the Miller Lite slogan told readers the beer was "Filling, and less delicious." Similar blunders are often made by Anglos trying to impress Spanish-speaking pals. But if Latinos are amused by **mangled** Spanglish, they also recognize these goofs as a sort of friendly acceptance. As they might put it, no problema. ***(The wide use of Spanglish among advertisers and the profound influential of Spanglish in commercial)***

Significant Words and Phrases

- Anglo
Britisher.
- handy
useful
- bemuse
cause to be confused
- linguistic
related to language
- hispanicized
make something like spanish
- hispanic
people from spanish
- fracture
breaking some hard issue
- farewell
politely depart
- detour
a roundabout road
- languorous
lazy and lack spirit
- mystify
make confused
- slang
informal phrases in language
- collide
crash together

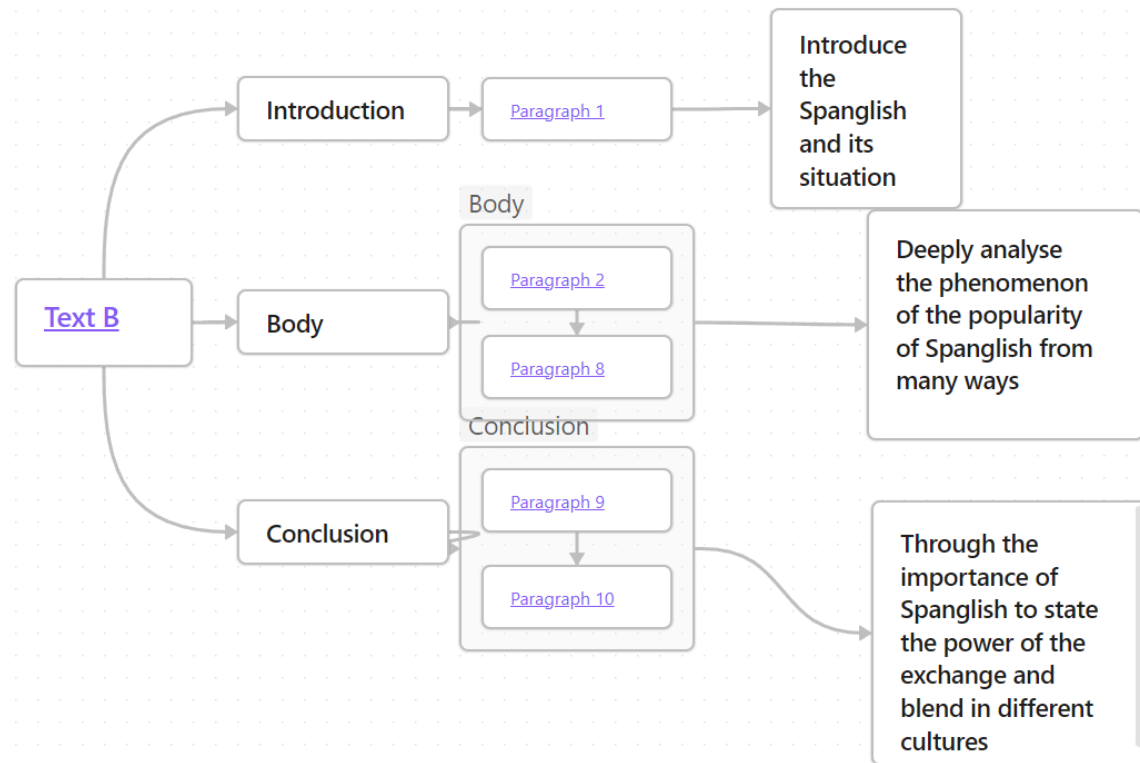
- wield
have and exercise
 - sprinkle
splash some liquid
 - gaffe
socially awkward
 - mangle
make something broken
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Topic Idea

This article through the phenomenon of the popularity of Spanglish expresses the exchange and blend between different cultures in American.

Structure

Structure of Text B



Activity 3

Task 1

Task 1 Think critically about the content of Text B and discuss the following questions in groups.

1. What is the purpose of this essay?
2. How does Janice Castro define Spanglish? Summarize the features of Spanglish discussed in this essay. You can search online for more examples of Spanglish.
3. What is Castro's attitude toward Spanglish? How would a language purist respond to her attitude? Where do you stand in this debate?
4. How did Spanglish come into being? Why has it become more and more popular among Hispanic-Americans, especially Mexican-Americans? Do some research online and share your findings and thoughts.
5. In Paragraph 3, Castro refers to the "melting pot" that the US is often said to be. Explain the reference to the US as a melting pot. Do you think the US today is a melting pot or a salad bowl? Why?

1. The essay through the popularity of Spanglish shows the exchange and blend among different cultures from different countries in America.
 2. Janice Castro defined Spanglish as a free-form blend of Spanish and English. Spanglish has the universality, variety and similarity to English.
The examples of Spanglish: [What Is Spanglish? Is It a Real Language?](#)
 3. Castro approves Spanglish and supports its blend and development.
A language purist might disagree with his attitude since the Spanglish is a blend of Spanish and English rather than pure Spanish or English.
I support Castro's attitude since language is a tool of culture expression thus the Spanglish is the representation of the blend of Spanish and English culture and serves as the tool of communicating between different cultures.
 4. Spanglish comes into being in the process of the blend of the American and Hispanic.
Since the daily communication and the education in the school is through Spanglish among those people.
The especial popularity of Spanglish among Mexican-Americans is due to the historical war between America and Mexico and the territory dispute between them.
In my opinion, the blend of Spanish and English is the representation of the colonial of America. It shows the root of the cultures in America.
 5. The US is the colony of England in the past and the people and the cultures in the US originate from other countries and regions. So it refers to a melting pot.
In my opinion today the US is not still a melting pot or a salad bowl since the US excludes the outer culture now and refuses to communicate with the world.
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Softening Modifiers

During the first half of the 20th century a significant number of cultural anthropologists **ventured out to study** a wide variety of the world's indigenous societies. As these anthropologists began to describe the lifestyles of these primarily non-Western (non-European) indigenous peoples, they soon realized that comprehending the cultural logic (the knowledge and rules governing cultural behavior) of a given group of people involved learning the indigenous language. Moreover, these anthropologists **recognized** that language **seemed to be** the primary vehicle by which culture is learned. As cultural anthropology as a discipline has developed through the years, **most** anthropologists who conduct fieldwork (ethnographers) have asked important questions regarding the nature of the relationship between language and culture. **The relationship** between language and culture **is** complex and, as the numerous and vociferous debates on the subject attest, **not well understood**.

Perhaps the strongest statement favoring the view of a close relationship between language and culture is the Sapir-Whorf hypothesis. The name of this hypothesis is taken from the names of two famous linguists: Edward Sapir and Benjamin Whorf. In its most basic form the Sapir-Whorf hypothesis is the assumption that the language a person learns actually structures and organizes how that person views or perceives the world. Thus, culture (what a person has learned) is encoded (symbolically organized) into language; as a person acquires knowledge of a language, he or she also develops a particular view of reality.

Testing this hypothesis has proved difficult. In their attempts to uncover the relationships among language, culture, and perception, **some** linguistic anthropologists have focused on differences in the ways phonology (the sound systems of languages), word choice, and grammar are organized in different language systems. **It was assumed** that differences in language structure would influence differences in how people tend to see the world (comparing languages and worldview). For example, linguists have noted that bilingual speakers sometimes shift back and forth from one language to another (code switching) to select language elements that most closely express their thoughts. Other studies have focused on grammar and word choice. In 1958 the linguists John Carroll and Joseph Casagrande

attempted to test the Sapir-Whorf hypothesis by comparing two populations of Navajo speakers. Their test was concentrated on dominant Navajo speakers who also spoke English as a second language, and English-speaking Navajos whose second language was Navajo. Speakers from each of the populations were asked to construct sentences selecting verbs that attach *blue rope* and *yellow rope* to the objects. Other objects, such as blue sticks, were included in the sample to control for both the shape and color. Carroll and Casagrande **concluded** that primary Navajo speakers selected verbs for handling (Navajo terms for picking up, grasping, holding, and so forth) on the basis of the shape (the physical form) of the noun/objects. In other words, certain verbs were selected by the speakers on the basis of language-specific grammatical rules founded on verb association with classifications of nouns according to shape. The English-dominant Navajo children **tended to** select verbs for the handling of the same objects according to color criteria. Carroll and Casagrande **argued** that the differences in grammatical rules and word choice between the two forms of Navajo (that is, the selection of a verb based on either the shape or the color of the object to be handled) predisposed speakers of these two populations to view aspects of the objects differently. The dominant Navajo speakers focused on shape as the most important feature of the objects. The dominant English speakers, although they were using Navajo for the test, focused on color as the most salient feature of the objects.

Critics of this test have suggested that differences in perception resulting from differences in language structure have not been proven to exist. Instead, the experiment demonstrates how, when constructing sentences, speakers use **slightly** different versions of the same language to select **somewhat** different grammatical rules; members of both populations still see the objects in the same fundamental way. Therefore, **if the critics are correct**, language does not predispose speakers to see the objects differently; they all see the objects in much the same way.